

YOUR FIRST PAPER

A Field Guide to Phloem

A calm, local-first desk for reading papers, leaving useful traces, and finding your way back.



Start here

1

Choose this note

On the wall, one click selects a paper and shows its field notebook.

2

Open the notebook

Click the selected note again, or choose Continue reading.

3

Make one trace

Move the guide, mark a sentence, or write a short margin note.

01 - GATHER

Build a reading wall

The wall is a working surface, not an inbox to conquer. Keep what helps you think.

1

Add a paper

Drop a PDF or folder, paste a direct PDF link, or pick from your connected GitHub folder.

2

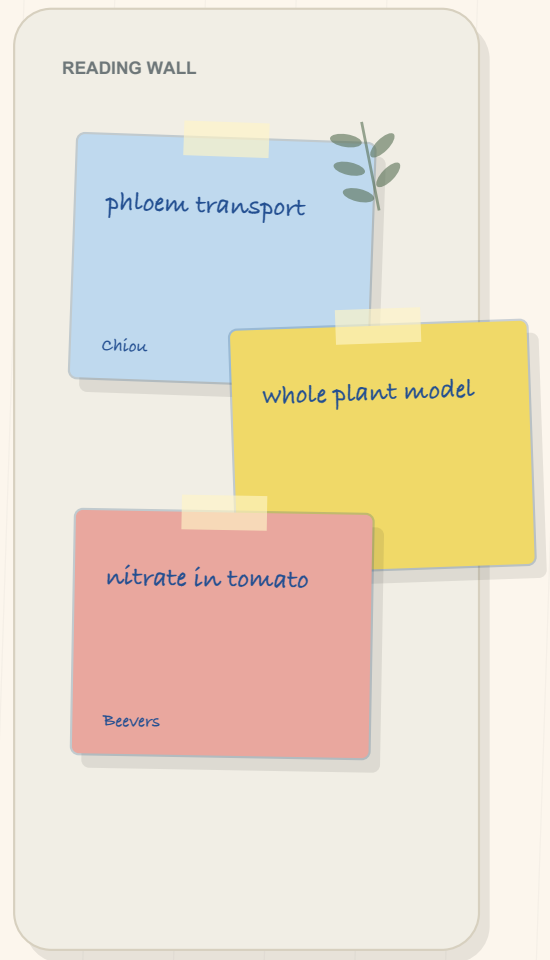
Select with one click

The note straightens and its notebook appears beside the wall. Click again to start reading.

3

Find it later

Search titles, authors, and tags. Sort by last touched, date added, title, author, or progress.



Tip: tags create useful connections between papers without forcing a folder system.

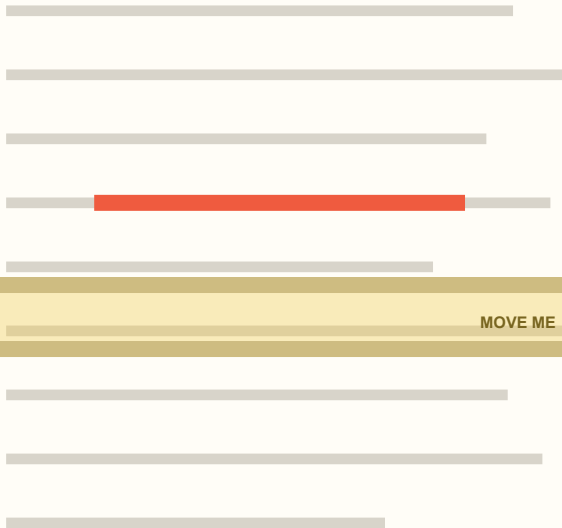
02 - FOCUS

Read with less friction

The page stays central. Tools appear around it only when they help.

Pressure flow in the phloem

A small sample page



Guide

Drag the yellow bar to hold your place.

Fit / zoom

Make dense figures and small labels comfortable.

Reflow

Switch to rebuilt text when the original page is cramped.

Recall

Hide the page briefly and explain the idea in your own words.

03 - NOTICE

Leave evidence for future you

A mark should shorten the next visit, not recreate the whole paper.

MARK**Keep one line**

Highlight a sentence that changes the model in your head.

MARGIN**Write for return**

Write the smallest note that will restore the context later.

LOOK UP**Resolve a term**

Select a short term for a definition and a source-linked image.

ASK**Save the gap**

Save a question when a passage deserves a second pass.

If a note cannot help you re-enter the thought, make it smaller.

04 - REMEMBER

Return without a streak

Phloem keeps questions near the paper. Review is a shelf you can visit, not a score that chases you.



A good saved question

What evidence would make this mechanism fail?

05 - KEEP

A desk that travels carefully

Papers and notes begin on this device. Add sync only when it makes your own workflow safer.

LOCAL FIRST

Your library works without an account. PDFs live in this browser's local storage.

OPTIONAL SYNC

Use Google Drive app data, or encrypted GitHub sync, when you need the same library on several devices.

BACKUP

Export a portable JSON backup for notes and metadata. Keep original PDFs separately too.

BROWSER EXTENSION

Right-click a PDF link or use the toolbar button to send it directly into Phloem.

Your first five minutes

1. Open this guide
2. Move the reading bar
3. Mark one line
4. Write one margin note
5. Return to the wall

